

D788

Domain Driven Design

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

At an insurer founded in 1952, “policy” in Underwriting means a risk being priced, while in Billing it means a payment schedule. A team of 6 proposes one shared Policy class holding every field both departments use. What is the better design?

- A. Use the definition from whichever department is older.
- B. Rename Billing’s term and then merge both into one model.
- C. Model Policy separately in Underwriting and Billing contexts, and map between them.
- D. One shared Policy class with every field from both departments.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

At a clinic with 4 locations, developers call it a “Record” in code, while clinic staff say “Visit.” Meetings need constant translation, and bugs come from misunderstandings. What should the team do?

- A. Let each location choose its own term.
- B. Keep “Record” in code and maintain a glossary.
- C. Use the staff’s term “Visit” in conversation, code, and tests.
- D. Train clinic staff to say “Record.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A logistics startup wins customers because of its route-optimization engine. It also needs payroll and email. It has 20 engineers and just raised a Series A round. Where should it put its deepest modeling effort?

- A. Whatever area the new investors ask about.
- B. Route optimization; buy payroll and email off the shelf.
- C. Payroll, since every company needs it.
- D. Build every area in-house with equal effort.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A subdomain is needed to run the business and is specific to it, but gives no competitive advantage. What type is it, and how much should the company invest?

- A.** Core, because every subdomain is core.
- B.** Generic; buy an off-the-shelf product.
- C.** Core; give it the best people.
- D.** Supporting; build it simply or outsource it, with less effort than the core.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

In a shipping system, a Customer can change name and address and still be the same customer. Addresses are printed on 3 label formats. Two addresses with the same street, city, and postal code are interchangeable. How should they be modeled?

- A.** Both are entities with their own IDs.
- B.** Customer is an entity; Address is a value object.
- C.** Address is an entity because it prints on several labels.
- D.** Customer is a value object; Address is an entity.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A Money value object holds amount 50 and currency USD. The price changes to 60. What should the code do?

- A.** Replace it with a new Money object of 60 USD.
- B.** Give Money an ID so its changes can be tracked.
- C.** Set the existing object's amount field to 60.
- D.** Block the change; value objects can never change a price.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An Order aggregate contains OrderLines. The rule is that an order total may not exceed the customer's \$5,000 credit limit. A developer's reporting script inserts OrderLines straight into the table. The order module was written last quarter. What is the fix?

- A. Run a nightly batch job to flag orders over the limit.
- B. Allow OrderLines to be added only through methods on the Order root.
- C. Rewrite the order module because it is new.
- D. Make OrderLine its own aggregate root.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Outside code needs to change the quantity on one OrderLine inside an Order aggregate. What is the correct path?

- A. Load the OrderLine by its ID and edit it directly.
- B. Update the quantity with a direct SQL statement.
- C. Add a separate repository for OrderLines.
- D. Call a method on the Order, which updates the line and checks its rules.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

When an order is placed, the Shipping and Loyalty contexts must react. Today Ordering calls both directly and fails whenever Loyalty is down. Loyalty is maintained by a team of 3. What is the better design?

- A. Ordering sends a PlaceOrder command to each context.
- B. Add staff to the Loyalty team so it is up more often.
- C. Merge Loyalty into Ordering so no call is needed.
- D. Ordering publishes an OrderPlaced event; Shipping and Loyalty subscribe to it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A new Claims context must read from a 25-year-old mainframe whose model uses cryptic codes and mixes concepts. The mainframe team works in another city and will not change it. Which pattern protects the new model?

- A. An anti-corruption layer that translates mainframe data into the Claims model.
- B. A shared kernel owned by both teams.
- C. Move the mainframe team to the same city.
- D. Conformist: adopt the mainframe's model as is.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Two teams jointly own a small part of their models, and any change to it needs both teams to agree. Which context-mapping pattern is this?

- A. Shared kernel.
- B. Conformist.
- C. Customer-supplier.
- D. Anti-corruption layer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An Order aggregate holds the full Customer aggregate inside it. Saving an order locks and rewrites customer data, causing conflicts when support staff update phone numbers. The system handles 800 orders per hour. What change fixes this?

- A. Merge Order and Customer into one larger aggregate.
- B. Raise the database lock timeout.
- C. Have Order hold only the Customer's ID.
- D. Cap orders at fewer per hour.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

At an insurer ~~founded in 1952~~, “policy” in Underwriting means a risk being priced, while in Billing it means a payment schedule. ~~A team of 6 proposes~~ one shared Policy class holding every field both departments use. What is the better design?

Target word: model a term with two meanings **Decides:** The word means different things in two contexts.

A	Camouflage	Company history does not decide the model.
B	Adjacent category	A rename still forces two meanings into one class.
C	Correct	Each bounded context keeps its own clear meaning.
D	Dropped element	Drops the boundary, creating a bloated, confusing model.

2. Answer C Concept 2

At a clinic ~~with 4 locations~~, developers call it a “Record” in code, while clinic staff say “Visit.” Meetings need constant translation, and bugs come from misunderstandings. What should the team do?

Target word: fix the language gap **Decides:** Two words for one concept.

A	Camouflage	The location count does not matter; it adds more words.
B	Dropped element	Keeps the translation that causes the bugs.
C	Correct	A ubiquitous language removes translation.
D	Inverted operation	The model should follow the domain experts, not the reverse.

3. Answer B Concept 3

A logistics startup wins customers because of its route-optimization engine. It also needs payroll and email. It has 20 engineers and ~~just raised a Series A round~~. Where should it put its deepest modeling effort?

Target word: where to invest modeling **Decides:** Route optimization is the competitive edge.

A	Camouflage	Funding does not define the core domain.
B	Correct	Route optimization is the core domain; the rest are generic.
C	Confusion set	Common need makes it generic, not core.
D	Absolute language	Spreads effort away from what sets the firm apart.

4. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

A subdomain is needed to run the business and is specific to it, but gives no competitive advantage. What type is it, and how much should the company invest?

Target word: classify from the description **Decides:** Needed and specific, but not a differentiator.

A	Absolute language	The categories exist to guide unequal investment.
B	Adjacent category	Generic is common to all firms; this one is specific to the company.
C	Confusion set	Core means competitive advantage.
D	Correct	Supporting subdomains are necessary but not differentiating.

5. Answer B Concept 4

In a shipping system, a Customer can change name and address and still be the same customer. ~~Addresses are printed on 3 label formats.~~ Two addresses with the same street, city, and postal code are interchangeable. How should they be modeled?

Target word: entity vs. value object **Decides:** Customer keeps identity; equal addresses are interchangeable.

A	Dropped element	Ignores that equal addresses are interchangeable.
B	Correct	Identity persists for Customer; Address is defined by its values.
C	Camouflage	Printing does not give it identity.
D	Inverted operation	Reverses which one has identity.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A Money value object holds amount 50 and currency USD. The price changes to 60. What should the code do?

Target word: how to change a value object **Decides:** Value objects are immutable.

A	Correct	Value objects are swapped, not edited.
B	Adjacent category	Adds identity it does not need.
C	Confusion set	Mutation treats it like an entity.
D	Absolute language	The price can change by replacing the object.

7. Answer B Concept 5

An Order aggregate contains OrderLines. The rule is that an order total may not exceed the customer's \$5,000 credit limit. A developer's reporting script inserts OrderLines straight into the table. ~~The order module was written last quarter.~~ What is the fix?

Target word: protect the invariant **Decides:** Lines are added without passing through the root.

A	Adjacent category	Detects violations after the fact instead of preventing them.
B	Correct	The root enforces the credit-limit rule on every change.
C	Camouflage	Its age is not the problem.
D	Confusion set	Splits the rule across aggregates so nothing enforces it.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

Outside code needs to change the quantity on one OrderLine inside an Order aggregate. What is the correct path?

Target word: route a change through the root **Decides:** Only the root is reachable from outside.

A	Dropped element	Bypasses the root and its checks.
B	Inverted operation	Skips the domain model entirely.
C	Adjacent category	Repositories exist per aggregate root, not inner parts.
D	Correct	The root mediates all changes.

9. Answer D Concept 6

When an order is placed, the Shipping and Loyalty contexts must react. Today Ordering calls both directly and fails whenever Loyalty is down. ~~Loyalty is maintained by a team of 3.~~ What is the better design?

Target word: decouple reactions **Decides:** Ordering should not depend on others being up.

A	Confusion set	A command asks for action; an event records what happened.
B	Camouflage	Team size does not remove the direct dependency.
C	Inverted operation	Couples the contexts more tightly.
D	Correct	A past-tense domain event lets others react independently.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A new Claims context must read from a 25-year-old mainframe whose model uses cryptic codes and mixes concepts. The mainframe team ~~works in another city~~ and will not change it. Which pattern protects the new model?

Target word: context-map pattern **Decides:** An unchangeable, messy upstream model.

A	Correct	It keeps legacy concepts from leaking in.
B	Adjacent category	Needs joint ownership, which the mainframe team refuses.
C	Camouflage	Location does not change the upstream model.
D	Confusion set	Imports the cryptic model the team wants to avoid.

11. Answer A Concept 7 · transfer

Two teams jointly own a small part of their models, and any change to it needs both teams to agree. Which context-mapping pattern is this?

Target word: name the pattern **Decides:** Jointly owned, shared piece.

A	Correct	A small shared model changed only by agreement.
B	Confusion set	One side simply adopts the other's model.
C	Adjacent category	One team serves the other; nothing is jointly owned.
D	Inverted operation	Isolates models rather than sharing them.

12. Answer C Concept 8

An Order aggregate holds the full Customer aggregate inside it. Saving an order locks and rewrites customer data, causing conflicts when support staff update phone numbers. ~~The system handles 800 orders per hour.~~ What change fixes this?

Target word: fix cross-aggregate conflicts **Decides:** Order embeds another aggregate.

A	Inverted operation	Bigger aggregates cause more conflicts.
B	Adjacent category	Treats the symptom; the coupling stays.
C	Correct	Referencing by ID keeps each aggregate small and separately saved.
D	Camouflage	Volume is not the design flaw.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Bounded context	A model and its terms hold one meaning inside an explicit boundary; the same word can mean different things in different contexts.	Building one enterprise-wide model that serves every department.	One word used with different meanings by different teams.
2	Ubiquitous language	Developers and domain experts use the same terms in talk, code, and tests within a context.	Keeping technical names and translating with a glossary.	Developers and experts using different words for one thing.
3	Core, supporting, and generic subdomains	Invest the best modeling effort in the core domain that sets the business apart; keep supporting ones simple and buy generic ones.	Building everything in-house with equal effort.	A stated competitive advantage alongside common needs like payroll.
4	Entity vs. value object	An entity has an identity that persists through change; a value object is defined only by its values and is immutable.	Giving every object an ID, or mutating value objects.	Whether two objects with equal attributes are interchangeable.
5	Aggregate and aggregate root	Outside code changes an aggregate only through its root, which enforces the aggregate's invariants.	Editing inner objects directly for convenience.	A business rule spanning the parts of one cluster.
6	Domain events	A domain event records something that happened (past tense) so other parts can react without tight coupling.	Chaining synchronous calls, or naming events as commands.	Several contexts must react when something occurs.
7	Context mapping patterns	An anti-corruption layer translates a foreign model; a shared kernel is a jointly owned piece; a conformist adopts the upstream model as is.	Letting a legacy model leak into the new one.	An upstream system that will not change, or two teams sharing code.
8	Reference other aggregates by ID	Keep aggregates small and refer to other aggregates by identity, not by holding them.	Embedding whole aggregates, which causes lock conflicts.	Saving one aggregate rewrites another.

Course scope (public description): This course covers key concepts of Domain Driven Design, including bounded context, context mapping, subdomains, entities, value objects, aggregates, aggregate roots, domain events, and their relation to other design patterns. Students will learn practical implementation strategies, collaboration with domain experts, model refinement, documentation, critiques, and case studies.